

Investigation Report HSE-INC-2026-018

High-potential near miss – dropped object on MV Sea Atlas, Harrow Bay Offshore Wind

Hannah Weber · 19 June 2026 · HSE-INC-2026-018

Field	Details
Incident number	HSE-INC-2026-018
Date / time	3 June 2026, 10:40
Location	MV Sea Atlas (jack-up installation vessel, Atlas Marine Contractors), Harrow Bay site, pile gripper frame upper level
Classification	Near miss – dropped object, high potential (fatality) ; no injuries, no damage
Investigation method	ICAM (Incident Cause Analysis Method)
Investigation team	Yusuf Demir (lead, Weyland HSE Advisor Offshore), HSE Superintendent Atlas Marine Contractors, Felix Brandt (Offshore Construction Manager); reviewed by Hannah Weber
Contract	WE-CON-2025-040 (vessel charter MV Sea Atlas)

1. What happened

During preparations for the upending of the next monopile, two riggers were adjusting the hydraulic pads of the pile gripper frame on its upper level, about 22 m above the main deck. One rigger put a **2.3 kg ratchet spanner** (3/4" drive) on the handrail kick plate to free his hands for a radio call. When the gripper frame was slewed a few degrees, the spanner slid off the kick plate, struck a handrail on the lower level and landed on the main deck about **2.5 m from a deck foreman** who was walking along the normal walkway outside the barriered drop zone.

The deck foreman was not injured. The crane operator stopped all operations immediately; the shift supervisor called an all-stop and informed the Weyland client representative at 10:52.

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

hse-sea-atlas-deck

The open working deck of a large jack-up installation vessel at sea, a huge yellow monopile lying on the deck in a gripper frame, deck crew in orange coveralls and helmets keeping clear of a barriered zone, crane boom overhead, grey sky.

Main deck of MV Sea Atlas with the pile gripper frame (illustration of the work area)

2. Potential severity

Using the DROPS calculator, a 2.3 kg object falling 22 m (energy ≈ 496 J) is in the *fatal* range even for a person wearing a helmet. The event is therefore classified as a high-potential (HiPo) near miss.

3. Analysis (ICAM)

Level	Findings
Absent / failed defences	Tool not tethered; drop zone barrier sized for vertical drop (5 m) but object deflected off handrail; no toe-board mesh on gripper frame upper level
Individual / team actions	Rigger placed tool on kick plate to answer a radio call; buddy did not challenge
Task / environmental conditions	Time pressure: weather window closing in 6 hours; slewing of gripper started without positive confirmation that the upper level was clear of loose items
Organisational factors	Atlas Marine tool tethering rule only for tools > 5 kg; Weyland requirement (all tools at height) not in the bridging document; tool inventory check at height not practised

4. Root causes

- Gap between the Weyland dropped objects standard and the vessel contractor's procedures (bridging document incomplete).
- Drop zone design did not consider deflection of falling objects from structures.
- No 'clear deck above' check before moving the gripper frame.

5. Actions

#	Action	Owner	Due	Status
1	Safety stand-down on all Harrow Bay vessels	Felix Brandt	2026-06-04	Done
2	Safety alert SA-2026-04 to all contractors and Weyland sites	Hannah Weber	2026-06-05	Done
3	Tethering of all hand tools at height, rated tethers for tools up to 6.8 kg	Atlas Marine Contractors	2026-06-10	Done
4	Update bridging document WE-CON-2025-040 with Weyland dropped objects standard	Yusuf Demir	2026-06-15	Done
5	Extend drop zones	Atlas Marine	2026-06-30	Done

	to 10 m around the gripper frame and add mesh to upper-level handrails	Contractors		
6	Add 'clear deck above' confirmation to the slewing procedure	Atlas Marine Contractors	2026-06-20	Done
7	DROPS survey on all vessels	Yusuf Demir	2026-06-30	Done
8	Share lessons with Asset Operations (tool tethering in nacelles)	Hannah Weber	2026-07-15	Done

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

hse-tool-tethering

Close-up of a worker's gloved hands attaching a coiled tool lanyard to a heavy ratchet spanner, a tool belt with tethered tools on a steel platform, safety harness visible, offshore daylight.

Tethered tools – now mandatory for all work at height on Harrow Bay

6. Sign-off

Role	Name	Date
Investigation lead	Yusuf Demir	18 June 2026
HSE Manager	Hannah Weber	19 June 2026
Project Director	Elena Márquez	19 June 2026